The R&AW worried that anti-Ziaur Rahman elements in Bangladesh had lost their lustre, even though hero-worship had immortalised Sheikh Mujib. The new government in Dhaka used anti-corruption and arms recovery drives to keep the few remaining followers of Sheikh Mujib on the run and Suntook believed that pro-Mujib elements would not support a national government in exile. However, he also felt that the Jatiya Samajtantrik Dal (JSD) headed by Major Jalil which had infiltrated the armed forces to a certain extent could become a potent force against Ziaur Rahman and his allies. The JSD, the R&AW knew, was in open conflict with Zia, and was probably the best-organised and most cohesive political force in Bangladesh. The JSD had a sizeable following in the armed forces and the R&AW was aware that it was solely responsible for encouraging widespread indiscipline. A R&AW report said:

This indiscipline has—to some extent— been subdued by Ziaur Rehman's promises to take necessary steps for alleviating the grievances of the other ranks but demands are so far reaching that it is unlikely that the present administration would be able to actually meet them. The seeds of further discontent in the armed forces are, therefore, ever present. After the arrest of the JSD leaders, the administration has stepped up its drive to round up prominent JSD personalities even at the district and sub-divisional level. Quite a few have been rounded up, but it is unlikely that the regime has been able to break the back of the movement. The crackdown has, however, compelled the JSD to go underground in order to reorganise and reactivate its cadres. Whilst the philosophy of its leadership is incompatible with that of the pro-Mujib Awami League activists, we have been receiving reports of the JSD making efforts at establishing an alliance of convenience with straw leaders to form a combined opposition against the present regime. The Marxist-Leninist